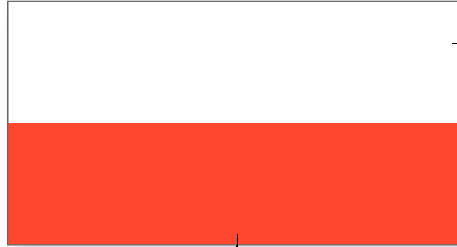


Poland

Ratio: 5:8 **Adopted:** August 1, 1919 **Usage:** National

The bicolor design was adopted after the World War I. Red and white were taken from the 13th century arms.



White represents a desire for peace

In the past red was said to represent socialism

Europe



Poland is strategically placed in Europe and its borders have constantly shifted. They were last altered after World War II, in 1945.

The red and white colors of the flag have been used since the 13th century, although they did not become the official national colors until 1831. They were taken from the colors of the national arms, first recorded in 1295.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms traditionally shows a white eagle on a red field. This emblem has remained more or less unchanged throughout Poland's turbulent history. The coat of arms was used by the Kingdom of Poland until its fall in 1795, and was re-adopted by the newly-declared republic around 1918/19, when a zigzag border and crown were

added. The border and the crown were both dropped under the communist administration, but the crown was restored in 1993.

THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF POLAND

Under communist rule from 1945–1989, white was commonly said to represent the people's desire for peace, and during this period, red stood for socialism. The flag was re-confirmed as the national flag by the new government in 1992.

The plain bicolored flag is used for general purposes on land. When at sea the flag is charged with the state arms in the center. Poland also has a swallow-tailed ensign, which is also charged with the state arms.